Nader Hotait

Sociology, Research,
and Data Science.

Academic Page
nader.hotait@hu-berlin.de
hotait@dezim-institut.de
0000-0003-4211-5300
linkedin.com/in/nader-hotait

WORK EXPERIENCE

DeZIM Berlin, Germany
Postdoc 2025 – Present

- DeZIM: German Center for Integration and Migration Research
- Consesus and Conflict Department
- National Monitoring of Discrimination and Racism (NaDiRa)

Humboldt University of Berlin Berlin, Germany
Postdoc 2021 – Present

- Berlin Institute for Integration and Migration Research (BIM).
- Founder and Director: Digital Muslim Studies Lab
- Project (Lead): "Media Diets and Democratic Values (MEDIVA)".
- Project (Lead): "Radicalization Potentials on TikTok (RaPoTik)".
- Project: "German Islam as an alternative to Islamism? (D:ISLAM)".

Alexander von Humboldt Institute for Internet and Society (HIIG) Berlin, Germany
Fellow 2026

- Internet and Society Fellowship 2026 – Focus Area: "Democratic Change and Knowledge"
- Six-week in-person fellowship incl. collaborative research sprint on trust in expertise, AI, and democratic knowledge orders

Transformakers GmbH Berlin, Germany
Lead Data Scientist 2024

- Collecting and Analyzing Online Data on Online Communities.
- Developing evidence-based policy recommendations.

London School of Economics (LSE) London, UK
Visiting Research Student 2023

SKILLS

</> R · Python · Stata · LaTeX
Git · NVivo · MAXQDA
SQL · TensorFlow

German · native
English · fluent
Arabic · native
French · proficient

ACADEMIC INTERESTS

Subjects	Sociology of the Internet
	Extremism and Radicalization
	Digital Religion
	Culture and Politics
	Racism and Discrimination
Methods	Computational Methods
	Natural Language Processing
	Surveys and Experiments
	Non-probability Designs
	Mixed-Methods

FREELANCE

2026 **LAKA**
Training material; Extremism

2025 **BBF e.V.**
Study report; partnership violence

- Data Science Institute
- Social Research Methods

University of Potsdam Potsdam, Germany
Research Associate 2019 – 2021

- Chair of Inequality Research and Social Stratification Analysis.

DeZIM Berlin, Germany
Freelance Researcher 2020 – 2021

- DeZIM: German Center for Integration and Migration Research.
- Project: "Spaces and possibilities of action against racism".

Berlin Social Science Center (WZB) Berlin, Germany
Research Assistant 2018 – 2019

- Center for Civil Society Research.

University of Potsdam Potsdam, Germany
Research Assistant 2018 – 2019

- Chair of General Sociology.

2025 **Forum Islam**
Muslim community Study

2024 **CLAIM Allianz**
AMR TikTok Analysis

2022 **UFA GmbH**
Employee Survey on DEI issues

2021 **#AFROZENSUS**
Drafting an online data explorer

EDUCATION

University of Mannheim & London School of Economics Mannheim, Germany
Dr. rer. soc., Sociology and Data Science 2021 – 2025

- **Oral defense:** May 6th, 2025. **Grade:** 0.4 (German grading)
- Graduate School of Economic and Social Sciences (Mannheim)
- Data Science Institute (LSE)

University of Potsdam Potsdam, Germany
M.A., Sociology 2018 – 2020

Humboldt University of Berlin Berlin, Germany
B.A., Social Sciences 2014 – 2018

ACADEMIC MEMBERSHIP

2022 – 2024 **Council for European Studies (CES)**
Research Coordinator of the Radicalism and Violence research network.

2022 – 2023 **The Atlantic Study of Islam and Muslims (ASIM)**
Coordinator of the research cluster CVE and "Radicalization"

AWARDS AND GRANTS

2026 **Deutscher Studienpreis (German Thesis Award)**
Nominated for my dissertation from 859 submissions
Körber Foundation

2023 **Humboldt and Princeton University Strategic Partnership**
Research grant for the project "Media Diets and Democratic Values" (MEDIVA)
Funding amount: 35,488€ EUR

2023 **Berlin State Commission against Violence**
Research grant for the project "Radicalization Potentials on TikTok" (RaPoTik)
Funding amount: 160,000 EUR

2022 **Young Scholar Award**
Award by the University of Mannheim for the project "Deconstructing Radical Content on TikTok"
Funding amount: 2,000 EUR

PUBLICATIONS

2026 **Anti-Muslim racism, TikTok, and radicalization**
Findings from a digital field experiment with Muslim TikTok users in Germany
BIM Research Report

2026 **Social exclusion and radicalisation in German Muslim TikTok users**
Presenting Experimental Findings
Book Chapter in "The Routledge International Handbook on Social Exclusion and Radicalisation"

2025 **Beyond the hijab: Performing religious identity on TikTok**
Social Compass

2025 **Possibilities for action in cases of racial discrimination**
How social constellations affect reaction behavior
Book Chapter in "Consensus and conflict in the post-migrant society"

2024 **Exploring the Role of TikTok for Intersectionality Marginalized Groups**
The Case of Muslim Female Content Creators in Germany
Frontiers in Political Science 2024, 6, 1496833

2024 **Exploring (Anti-)Radicalism on TikTok**
German Islamic Content Creators between Advocacy and Activism
Religions 2024, 15(10)

2024 **Culture, Migration, And Theology**
Types of Actors, Networks and Discourses of Anti-Muslim Racism on TikTok
Report for the Civil Society Situation Report on Anti-Muslim Racism
CLAIM – Allianz gegen Islam- und Muslimfeindlichkeit

2021 **Potentials of Natural Language Processing in the Study of Radicalism.**
A Methodological Exploration on the example of Hizb ut-Tahrir affiliated Twitter accounts.
Conference Proceedings of the Science Conference 2021
Center for Analysis and Research (German Federal Office for the Protection of the Constitution)

2021 **Response strategies to racism. The Importance of Contextual Factors**
for Strategies of Action in the Case of Racial Discrimination.
DeZIM Project Report

Media

2026 **Why did these churches burn? Rabbit hole**
Interview with tagesschau (ARD)
German, available here.

2026 **The good news. Few Muslims want to subvert European democracy**
Interview with The Economist
English, available here.

2026 **It is premature to speak of official failure**
Interview with nd
German, available here.

2026 **Alleged CSD attacker. Radicalization announced in advance**
Interview with TAZ
German, available here.

2026 **The AfD's Knife Crime Portal is Built on Bad Data**
Interview with Heist
English, available here.

2026 **The far-right lies to you about migrant crime, again**
Interview with The European Correspondant
English, available here.

2026 **War and displacement in Lebanon**
Radio interview with SWR

2026 **German Muslims and Ramadan**
TV interview with RBB Abendschau
German, available here.

2025 **Fact check: How fake news target Europe's Christmas markets**
Interview with Deutsche Welle (DW)
English, available here.

2025 **'Islamist' propaganda on social media – How does it work? And what can be done about it?**
Interview with ARD (world's largest public broadcaster)
German, Radio here; Instagram here.

2025 **'Islamist' tendencies in German-speaking countries**
Interview with ARD (world's largest public broadcaster)
German, i.a. available here.

2024 **TikTok: "Considered en vogue among extremists"**
Interview with WDR 5 Morgenecho (West German Broadcasting)
German, available here.

2021 **"Controversy is a selling point"**
Insights into research on the dissemination of extremist content on TikTok
Interview with Ufuq.de
German, available here.

Hosted and Organized Events

(New) Media and Migration: Methods, Tools, and Applications — Duisburg, Germany
Workshop — 2026

Fragmented and Contested? Debates on Racism in Media — Berlin, Germany
Workshop — 2026

MEDIVA (Media Diets and Democratic Values) — Berlin, Germany
Symposium — 2026

AI and Migration Studies — Berlin, Germany
Workshop — 2025

Radicalization Potentials on TikTok — Berlin, Germany
Symposium — 2024

Network for Empirical-Analytical Social Research on Muslims — Berlin, Germany

Conference 2024

“Anti-Muslim Realities” Berlin, Germany
Symposium 2023

“Media as a Fuel for Radicalization?” Berlin, Germany
Expert Talk 2023

D:Islam Webinar Series: “National Islams in ‘The West‘” Online
Webinars 2021-2022

PRESENTATIONS AND DISCUSSIONS

HIIG Berlin, Germany
Panel Discussion 2026
Panel: God and the machine

DeZIM-Institut Berlin, Germany
DeZIM_talk 2026
Presentation and Panel Discussion: Young Muslims between discrimination and radicalization in the digital sphere

Sozialpädagogisches Fortbildungsinstitut Berlin-Brandenburg (SFBB) Berlin, Germany
Conference 2026
Presentation: Radicalization on TikTok

Ministry of the Interior of North Rhine-Westphalia Düsseldorf, Germany
Workshop 2026
Presentation and Workshop: Online radicalization between myths and reality

Ministry for Social Affairs Baden-Württemberg / LAKA Stuttgart, Germany
Workshop 2026
Presentation and Workshop: Ultranationalism, hierarchical logics, and the fragmentation of Arabic-speaking communities

DeZIM-Institut Berlin, Germany
Workshop 2025
Presentation: Selective resonance of racially motivated homicides in German media debates

BAG RelEx Berlin, Germany
Symposium 2025
Presentation: From the mat to radicalization: martial arts as a gateway and intersecting factor in extremism

Media Authority Berlin-Brandenburg Berlin, Germany
Youth Council Meeting 2025
Presentation: Political Radicalization on TikTok

Violence Prevention Network Leipzig, Germany
Conference 2025
Keynote: Current evidence on online radicalization and its practical challenges

Universitas Diponegoro Semarang, Indonesia
Lecture Series 2025
Lecture: AI and Digital Religion: Practices and Implications

XIII. Future Forum Islam Frankfurt, Germany
Conference 2024
Workshop: Social networks and social polarization - the new media makers?

NAFS Berlin, Germany
Conference: Network for Empirical-Analytical Social Research on Muslims 2024
Presentation: Investigating TikTok's Role in Radicalizing Muslim Users in Germany

Council for European Studies Lyon, France
Conference: 30th International Conference of Europeanists 2024
Panel Chairs:
Islamism and Xenophobia in Europe: Dynamics of Extremism and Feedback Effects
Navigating the Radical Web: How the Internet Facilitates Extremism and What to Do about It
Presentations:
How Muslim TikTok Content Creators React To Islamophobia
Radicalization Potentials on TikTok - Presenting New Findings
Constructing Gendered Religious Identities - TikTok's Muslim Female Content Creators

Ufuq.de Berlin, Germany
Webtalk: Anwendung von KI-Tools in der zivilgesellschaftlichen Projektarbeit 2024
Presentation: Application of AI tools in Civil Society Project Work

Federal Agency for Civic Education Bonn, Germany
MasterClass: The Field of Islamism Prevention 2024
Panel Discussion: Civic education and Prevention, a Field of Tension?! - Reflecting on one's own Role in the Field of Islamism Prevention

NAFS Erlangen, Germany
Conference: Network for Empirical-Analytical Social Research on Muslims 2023
Presentation: Constructing Religious Identities TikTok's Muslim Female Content Creators

Lower Saxony Ministry of the Interior and Sport Hanover, Germany

Conference: Lower Saxony Competence Forum for the Prevention of Islamism 2023
Panel Discussion: Digital Threats - Opportunities and Challenges for the Prevention of Islamism

MZES-DeZIM Mannheim, Germany
Workshop: Social Science Meets Digital Data: Methods of Computational Social Science 2023
Presentation: Investigating radical content on TikTok - A computational approach.

Ufuq.de Berlin, Germany
Webtalk: Kollektive Emotionen in Radikalisierungsprozessen und die Rolle von TikTok 2022
Presentation: Collective emotions in radicalization processes and the role of TikTok.

MOTRA Wiesbaden, Germany
Conference: MOTRA-K 2022
Presentation: Potentials of radicalization on TikTok.

Council for European Studies Lisbon, Portugal
Conference: 28th International Conference of Europeanists 2022
Panel Chair: Islamism and Xenophobia in Europe: Dynamics of Extremism and Feedback Effects.
Presentation: Narratives of Xeno- and Islamophobia in Islamist Communication

Zentrum für Analyse und Forschung Berlin, Germany
Conference: Wissenschaftskonferenz 2021
Panel Chair: Ways into the Rabbit Hole
Presentation: Islamist strategies of radicalization